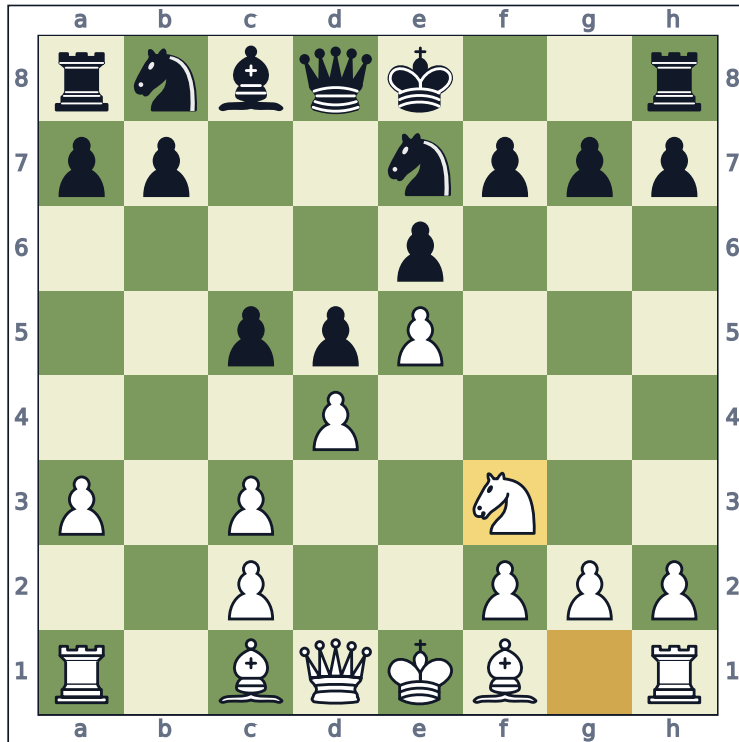


FRENCH DEFENSE

French Defense

ECO C19 | 14 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.40 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C19 covers French Defense. Black builds a d5-e6 center and accepts a temporarily restricted c8 bishop in exchange for a clear attack on White's center. The diagram uses the featured line French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Nf3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, support the e5 chain when it exists, and develop before beginning a kingside attack.

BLACK'S GOALS

Challenge d4 with ...c5, attack e5 with ...f6 when sound, and solve the c8 bishop deliberately.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...c5 is the basic break; ...f6 is the second. White often uses c3, f4-f5, or queenside play depending on the structure.

PIECE MAP

White's e5 pawn can gain space but needs support. Black's bad bishop often becomes active after ...b6 and ...Ba6 or after exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Both sides can misjudge the pawn chain: attack its base and calculate breaks rather than attacking where the chain is strongest. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c3, Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A sound, excellent defense with clear plans and rich counterplay, though cramped positions require patience.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C19 line

This section preserves all 14 names and defining routes assigned to C19 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Advance Variation, Smyslov Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 Ne7 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 c5 7. a4

002 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Advance Variation, Smyslov Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 Ne7 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 c5 7. a4 Qc7

003 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Nf3

004 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Nc6 7. Nf3 Nge7

005 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Nf3 Qc7

006 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Bd3 Nbc6 8. Nf3

007 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Nf3 Qc7 8. h4

008 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. a4 Nbc6 8. Nf3

009 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Nc6 7. Nf3 Qa5 8. Bd2 Nge7

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1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. a4 Nbc6 8. Nf3 Qa5 9. Bd2

011 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. a4 Nbc6 8. Nf3 Qa5 9. Qd2

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1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. a4 Nbc6 8. Nf3 Qa5 9. Bd2 Bd7

013 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. a4 Nbc6 8. Nf3 Qa5 9. Bd2 c4

014 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Positional Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. a4 Nbc6 8. Nf3 Qa5 9. Qd2 Bd7